

Periodic Assessment — CA-1

Class 5 · CBSE / NCERT · 2026-27

Class:	5	Subject:	EVS
Max Marks:	30	Duration:	1 Hour
Name:	_____	Roll No:	_____
Date:	_____	Difficulty:	Hard

Syllabus: Units 1-3 — Water: The Essence of Life, Journey of a River, The Mystery of Food, Our School: A Happy Place, Our Vibrant Country, Some Unique Places

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which of the following best explains why sea water cannot be directly used for drinking or irrigation? (1 Mark)

A. It is too cold	B. It contains a high amount of dissolved salt harmful in large quantities ✓
C. It has no water cycle	D. It never evaporates

2. A river system's "catchment area" refers to _____. (1 Mark)

A. the sea it flows into	B. the entire land area from which rain and streams drain into the river ✓
C. a bridge built over the river	D. the delta only

3. Which combination of nutrients would be most useful to recommend to someone recovering from illness and needing to rebuild strength? (1 Mark)

A. Only sugar and fried food	B. Proteins along with vitamins and minerals ✓
C. Only carbonated drinks	D. Only spices

4. Food poisoning most commonly occurs due to _____. (1 Mark)

A. eating fresh fruit	B. consuming contaminated or improperly stored food ✓
C. drinking boiled water	D. eating a balanced diet

5. A school council or student committee mainly helps a school function well by _____. (1 Mark)

A. increasing homework	B. giving students a voice in decisions and encouraging responsibility ✓
C. reducing the number of classes	D. replacing teachers

6. The phrase "unity in diversity" is best challenged (tested) when _____. (1 Mark)

A. people celebrate each other's festivals	B. people from different communities refuse to cooperate or respect each other ✓
C. different languages are spoken in different states	D. India has many geographic regions

7. UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India, such as certain forts and temples, are recognised mainly for _____. (1 Mark)

A. being the tallest buildings	B. their outstanding cultural or natural importance to humanity ✓
C. being the newest constructions	D. having the most visitors only

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Explain why desalination (removing salt from sea water) is not yet a common solution to water shortage everywhere. (2 Marks)

➤ Desalination requires expensive equipment and a lot of energy to remove salt from sea water, so it is costly and not practical for every place, especially areas without enough resources.

2. Why can a river that looks clean at its source become polluted by the time it reaches a big city? (2 Marks)

➤ As the river flows through towns and cities, factories, farms and homes release waste, chemicals and sewage into it, which gradually makes the once-clean water dirty and unsafe.

3. Explain how food habits passed down in a family can affect a child's long-term health. (2 Marks)

➤ If a family regularly eats balanced, home-cooked meals, children learn healthy habits that protect them for life, whereas a family that eats mostly junk food can pass on unhealthy habits leading to future health problems.

4. Discuss briefly why "best before" or expiry dates on packaged food are important to check. (2 Marks)

➤ Food after its expiry date may have lost nutrients or developed harmful bacteria, so checking the date helps avoid eating spoiled food that could make us sick.

5. Explain how a school's environment can influence a student's confidence and behaviour outside school. (2 Marks)

➤ A school that encourages respect, cooperation and fair treatment builds a student's confidence and teaches good behaviour, which the student then carries into their interactions with family and society outside school.

6. Why might preserving regional languages be considered as important as having one common national language? (2 Marks)

➤ Regional languages carry unique literature, history and culture of different communities, so protecting them preserves India's diversity, even while a common language helps people from different regions communicate with each other.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Analyse why water, although covering most of the Earth's surface, is still considered a scarce resource in many parts of the world. (3 Marks)

- Most of Earth's water is salty ocean water, which is not directly usable for drinking or farming.
- Of the small amount of fresh water available, much is locked in glaciers and polar ice, leaving only a small portion easily accessible in rivers, lakes and groundwater.
- Combined with pollution, wastage and growing population needs, this makes usable fresh water scarce despite water covering most of the planet.

2. Discuss how human settlements along a river's path can both benefit from and negatively affect the river. (3 Marks)

- Settlements benefit from the river through drinking water, irrigation for crops, transport and fishing, which is why many cities have historically grown along riverbanks.
- However, the same settlements can negatively affect the river by dumping waste, building dams that block natural flow, and over-extracting water for their growing needs.
- This shows a two-way relationship where careful management is needed to keep the benefit without causing lasting harm.

SECTION D — Long Answer / Descriptive Questions (5 Marks each)

1. India has great rivers, unique natural and man-made places, and immense cultural diversity. Discuss how these three aspects together shape India's identity, and explain the responsibility citizens have in protecting them. (5 Marks)

- India's rivers, such as the Ganga and Brahmaputra, have supported civilisations, agriculture and trade for thousands of years, making them central to the country's history and economy.
- Unique places like deserts, backwaters, hill stations and monuments showcase both the natural variety of India's geography and the skill of its people across centuries.
- Cultural diversity in languages, festivals and traditions adds richness, making India a country where many identities exist together as one nation.
- Citizens have a responsibility to protect these resources and places by avoiding pollution, respecting heritage sites, and valuing the diversity around them, ensuring that future generations can experience the same richness.